SONIA MALIK

AI Enablement & Adoption · Generative & Agentic AI Prototyping · Engineering Transformation · Responsible AI

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Prototype built for this role: https://soniamalik78-sys.github.io/prototypes/elevate-wf/

SUMMARY

Engineering leader with 24+ years in engineering and transformation leadership who started as a hands-on engineer and still builds. Takes AI from first experiment to everyday engineering practice: builds working prototypes, packages what works as reusable agents, prompts, templates and playbooks, coaches teams through adoption, and builds in security, testing, governance and human oversight from day one.

- **AI adoption at scale:** 350+ engineers on governed AI in 13 months, on an AI developer platform stood up in 6 months and designed to serve ~1,200 engineers (S&P Global).
- **Workforce enablement:** engagement 85% → 95% in 3 quarters through a skills assessment and peer pairing; 50+ engineers reskilled into automation at Prudential.
- **Hands-on builder:** builds GenAI prototypes and reference implementations with Claude Code, including ELEVATE (linked above); designed creator and judge agents with LLM-as-judge evaluation.
- **Responsible AI by default:** chaired the AI Governance Committee; reviewed 10+ AI tools; 0 autonomous production deploys; regulated sign-off 3 days → same day.

Core: AI Enablement & Adoption · Generative AI & Agentic AI · Prototypes, Proofs of Concept & Reference Implementations · Reusable Agents, Prompts & Playbooks · AI Learning & Development Strategy · Change Management & Workforce Enablement · Use-Case Discovery · Model Evaluation & Observability · Security, Data Protection, Governance & Human Oversight · Emerging AI Tool Evaluation · Standards & Best Practices · Executive Presentation & Stakeholder Communication · Mentoring & Coaching

SELECTED ACCOMPLISHMENTS: AI FROM PROTOTYPE TO DAILY PRACTICE

- **Adoption, not just access: 350+ engineers on governed AI in 13 months.** Made the safe path the easy one: approved models in VS Code (Claude among them), privacy, security and regulatory checks as required pipeline steps, a 32+ engineer platform team, and 8–10 tools consolidated into shared platforms.
- **Prototype to reusable agents: features per PI +30% over 3 PIs; production defects −20% in 6 months; NPS +5.** Found that 80% of requirements were one-liners and 60% of production bugs (across 1,450 incidents) were user-experience issues; introduced customer journeys and creator and judge agents that draft MVPs, features and BDD stories against configurable rubrics, with human validation.
- **Use case with business users: analysts' time to a recommended rating −30%** vs benchmark in UAT. Shaped Ratings AI decision support with analysts as the business users: it detects market events, alerts the analyst and recommends a rating with its rationale; the analyst decides. An A/B-tested dashboard built their trust.
- **Reusable assets and standards: 100+ scrum teams adopted one security testing framework**, shipped as a shared repository and templates with a CI/CD quality score that blocks promotion; S&P Dow Jones Indices picked it up next. Added log scrubbing so sensitive details never reach AI models.
- **People through the change: engagement 85% → 95% in 3 quarters; 17 promotions incl. 2 to Director**; Dev:QE ratio 2.5:1 → 4:1.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

S&P Global, New York, NY **August 2025 – September 2026**

Vice President, Head of Quality Engineering · Chair, AI Governance Committee

Senior Directors as direct reports; $70M+ budget; two business units. Mandate expanded to include AI PDLC.

- **AI developer platform:** **stood up in 6 months**, designed to serve ~1,200 engineers; **350+ engineers on governed AI in 13 months**; regression 9 days → daily; releases 2× in 3 months.
- **Enablement:** skills assessment and peer pairing across a 350+ global organization; **engagement 85% → 95%**; QE leaders embedded in delivery scrum teams plus a central framework team; presented the multi-year transformation strategy to executive leadership.
- **Governance:** chaired the AI Governance Committee (CISO, Risk, Compliance, Legal); **reviewed 10+ AI tools** under cybersecurity and controls; human approval enforced in the pipeline (**0 autonomous production deploys**); **regulated sign-off 3 days → same day**.
- **Security testing:** turned a stopped release (code, part legacy and part AI-generated) into a 4-stage framework: SAST, DAST, release-driven penetration testing, internal ethical hacking.

DoubleVerify (DV), New York, NY **July 2024 – August 2025**

VP of Product and Engineering – Head of Quality Engineering

VPs and Directors as direct reports; $35M budget; 200+ contractors across five countries.

- **AI-assisted engineering:** **manual effort −25%; test cycles −20%** with AI-assisted testing and predictive defect analysis, behind guardrails and human review gates; SOX findings closed with auditors.

Audible Inc., an Amazon company, Newark, NJ **August 2019 – April 2024**

QAE Director (CTO Office) – Consumer Domain QA Head

10 SDEs direct, 270+ indirect; $35–40M budget; scaled from 4 to 41 engineers plus 2 offshore centers.

- **Adoption across teams:** **manual effort −60% across 17 teams**; regression 5 days → 2; security champion training at Audible.
- **Outcomes:** **Sev2s, security vulnerabilities and launch risk each −30%**; **$50M+** revenue from the non-functional CoE; **$10M+** from geo-customization.
- **Machine learning:** applied machine learning to production incidents from 2022 to find repeat-causing patterns.

Prudential Insurance Company of America, Newark, NJ **December 2015 – August 2019**

Head of Quality Engineering (CIO Office) – Customer Office & Retirement

- **Reskilling at scale:** took in **150+ mainframe engineers; reskilled 50+ into automation**; moved 35+ roles with backup coverage.
- **Customer centricity:** **multi-product customers 3% → 5%, $100M revenue impact**, as quality lead for the unified customer dashboard.
- **Delivery:** **testing time −30% in 9 months; QA cost −50%**; UAT a week → 2–3 days across 5 business units; Customer Office QE scaled to 40+ FTEs for 10 scrum teams.

EARLIER EXPERIENCE

Pearson (QA Manager, 2012–2015) · SanPulse (2011) · TheMarkets.com (2006–2009) · Guardian Life (2005–2006) · Sasken (2003–2005) · HCL (Automated Tooling Support Engineer, 2002–2003) · Siemens (2001–2002)

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

Master of Science (Computer Applications) · Bachelor's in Computer Science, Kurukshetra University · Rutgers Mini MBA (Customer Centricity), certificate · SAFe Scrum Master · CSM · CSPO

AI & TECHNICAL SKILLS

Generative AI and agentic AI: creator and judge agents, LLM-as-judge evaluation with rubrics, human-in-the-loop, evaluation gates; familiar with RAG and MCP · AI coding tools: Claude Code, GitHub Copilot, Devin, CodeRabbit · Rapid prototyping and reference implementations · Python, Java, SQL · CI/CD, Azure DevOps, SAST/DAST · AWS, Azure · Responsible AI: NIST AI RMF, ISO/IEC 42001, EU AI Act